

Drew Voegele

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Design Executive: Experience Strategy, Design Studios and AI-Native Enterprise Platforms

SUMMARY

Design executive with 19 years at Microsoft turning ambiguous, cross-product opportunities into shipped platforms. Originated the concept that became Power BI Desktop and took it from pitch to general availability in about 10 months. Founded Studio X, Microsoft Cloud + AI's strategy and innovation design studio. Built and led the ~120-person design organization behind Microsoft Fabric, and led its shift to AI-native practice, where designers now ship front-end code. Known for changing what gets funded and built by pairing customer evidence with working proof, and for building teams that don't depend on him to run.

SELECTED IMPACT

- **Created a product line:** originated and was primary designer of the concepts that became Power BI Desktop and PowerBI.com, unifying three Excel add-ins into one end-to-end analytics experience. Pitched to the GM, greenlit, and shipped to general availability in July 2015, about 10 months after the pitch.
- **Accelerated an established market leader:** took over Power BI design as satisfaction and new-user growth were slowing. Raised Net Promoter Score (NPS) by more than 40% in two years while adoption kept climbing.
- **Built an organization at scale:** led the merged Power BI and Azure Data design orgs for six months before holding the title, then grew the org from ~50 to ~120 people across design, research, content, design engineering and DesignOps in about 18 months.
- **Unified the AI experience:** identified fragmentation across team-by-team Copilot experiences, pushed for one Copilot platform for Fabric, and won CTO and business support. My org drove it to the Unified Copilot Microsoft announced in September 2026.
- **Made design AI-native:** launched an AI for UX program. Every designer uses AI, and over 80% use GitHub Copilot in their IDE three or more days a week, the highest rate among the ten largest design orgs at Microsoft. Adoption reached 83% within 30 days of training, designer confidence rose from 59% to 84%, and content-design tooling measured an 80% productivity gain over three months.

EXPERIENCE

Microsoft · Sep 2006 – Present

Partner Design Director, Data Cloud Studio (Azure Data: Microsoft Fabric and Power BI) · Jan 2022 – Present

Design Director Jan 2022; Partner Design Director since Sep 2022.

Lead design for Microsoft's data and AI platform, Microsoft Fabric (Power BI, Data Factory, data engineering, data warehousing, real-time intelligence, governance), spanning interaction design, content design, design systems, design engineering and DesignOps.

- Merged the Power BI and Azure Data design teams into one studio and grew it from ~50 to ~120 people in about 18 months. Hired for product judgment (people who define success, measure outcomes and pivot) over visual polish, and developed new leaders from within.
- Set a single experience direction across all of Fabric's workloads: "super deck" briefings on every workload, a shared design system, and cohesion research that scores every experience against the pattern library.
- Identified fragmented, team-by-team Copilot experiences and advocated one Copilot platform. Won support from the CTO and business leadership, and my org (led by Jason Falk with Brent Sandifer) drove it to the Unified Copilot announced in September 2026.
- Reframed the design lifecycle as a cascade of decisions and matched AI to the jobs it does well. Launched an AI for UX program with 4 hours of protected learning per sprint. Every designer now uses AI, and over 80% use GitHub Copilot in their IDE three or more days a week, the highest rate among Microsoft's ten largest design orgs.
- Sponsored Nexus, a knowledge graph of the studio's research, strategy and plans with skills that turn it into cited, standards-checked work; designers use it inside product repos to ship code. Its front end, Zero, is an AI-native design environment built on code, where designers see what the AI is doing and collaborate. Together they target a measured gap: design could cover only about half of engineering's output.
- Established UX quality programs that tie a severity-by-priority fix standard to NPS. Alongside a company-wide quality push, Fabric Data Warehouse NPS nearly tripled and satisfaction rose 15 points.
- Built a research engine where every designer engages users regularly: tripled the Fabric user panel to ~3,000 participants.

- Used telemetry and customer evidence to challenge a mandated navigation model, then measured and corrected course; the product switcher was reduced from one context per workload to two.

Design Studio Lead, Power BI · Oct 2019 – Jan 2022

Led design for Power BI Desktop, PowerBI.com, mobile and embedded experiences (team of ~25).

- Raised NPS by more than 40% in two years as adoption kept climbing. Power BI was named a Leader in the Gartner Magic Quadrant for Analytics and BI Platforms (2020) and continues to build a gap.
- Introduced habituation-aware measurement, judging changes at four to eight weeks against an expected adaptation curve rather than two-week snapshots, so that good changes weren't rolled back before users adapted.
- Partnered with product and engineering to expand into adjacent markets; shipped Datamarts (self-service data warehousing) and Scorecards (goals and KPIs). That work laid the foundation for Fabric's developer platform.
- Grew the team's size and its balance of disciplines, and brought former Studio X designers into product roles.

Design Studio Chief, Studio X (Cloud + AI) · Mar 2016 – Sep 2019

Founded and led Microsoft Cloud + AI's strategy and innovation design studio, turning emerging hardware and data bets into working experiences, partner roadmaps and product commitments.

- Reframed "port Power BI to Surface Hub" as collaboration with data, and "put Power BI on HoloLens" as data for first-line workers in the physical world. Shipped Power BI for Surface Hub and Power BI for HoloLens (Microsoft Store, 2018).
- Designed and delivered the Cloud Collaboration Center, Azure's 184-display operations center for site reliability engineers: the visualization system, an SRE companion app that coordinated across war rooms, and a v2 redesign. In-room research after launch showed most operators couldn't read the wall from their seats; the redesign answered with fewer, larger signals and a minimum type size.
- Incubated and centralized Microsoft's IoT and blockchain design teams, growing the studio from 5 to ~20 people. Served as design liaison to Microsoft's hardware leadership.
- Originated Bifrost, a cross-application service unifying Power BI, Dynamics 365 and Office data for first-line workers on any device. It was developed with enterprise customers and presented to Cloud + AI and Business Applications leadership, and anticipated the unified back end Fabric Real-Time Intelligence builds today.

Design Manager, then UX Design Lead, Power BI Desktop (SQL Server BI) · Nov 2013 – Mar 2016

- Originated and was primary designer of the experience concepts that became Power BI Desktop and PowerBI.com. Built support with engineering and a Technical Fellow, and pitched up through leadership to approval.
- Led Power BI Desktop design from greenlight to general availability in July 2015, about 10 months after the pitch. Grew the team to six designers (five hired during delivery) and adopted Microsoft's new design language.
- Managed design for Power Pivot and Power Query, and served as design lead with the Excel team for cross-product consistency.

UX Researcher, then UX Designer, SQL Server Business Intelligence · Sep 2007 – Nov 2013

- Co-led strategic research on how people start and finish BI work (38 participants across 12 companies). Its personas and entry-to-exit journeys became the backbone of the Power BI Desktop concept four years later.
- Built a UX benchmark program that ran studies in parallel, like a game playtest, delivering results a month faster at ~85% lower cost.
- Led research for Microsoft's self-service BI (Power Pivot, Power View, Power Query, Analysis Services, Reporting Services), then moved into design: Power Query's information architecture, flows and style guide, including concept work that went into production.

Usability Engineer (contract via Volt), Microsoft Game Studios · Sep 2006 – Jun 2007

- Credited researcher on *Mass Effect* (Metacritic 91) and *Forza Motorsport 2* (Metacritic 90). Tuned combat, targeting, cover and menu usability, and used telemetry to set the Time Trials challenge ramp.

SKILLS

Experience strategy · Design studio leadership · AI-native and agentic experience design (human-agent collaboration, trust, delegation, intervention and recovery) · Product and portfolio strategy · Service design · Design systems and experience architecture · Design engineering and code-first prototyping · UX research and customer insight · DesignOps and organization design · Executive and cross-organization influence · Data, analytics and AI platforms (Microsoft Fabric, Power BI)

EDUCATION

M.A., Interaction Design and Design Management, University of Kansas, 2006. Pilot student who helped shape the graduate program.

B.S., Cognitive Psychology, University of Kansas, 2004. Research: first-time usability of Bluetooth devices for the Bluetooth SIG (Juola et al., 2005).